



153 Million Driver's Licenses for Sale

A CIA triad analysis of the IDScan.net breach behind the Nexus identity-theft service

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Case source: Krebs, B. (2026, September 1). FBI probes service selling 153M+ drivers licenses. Krebs on Security.

A year-long data drain at an ID-verification vendor

WHO

IDScan.net, an ID-verification vendor for Hertz, retailers and 1,000+ dispensaries. Victims: **153M+** U.S. and Canadian license holders.

WHAT

“Nexus,” a dark-web shop selling license scans (front, back, infrared, ultraviolet).

WHEN

Scans from **June 2025** onward; advertised **Aug. 31, 2026**.

HOW

“Continuously exfiltrating new data for **over a year**”: ~400K new records in one day.

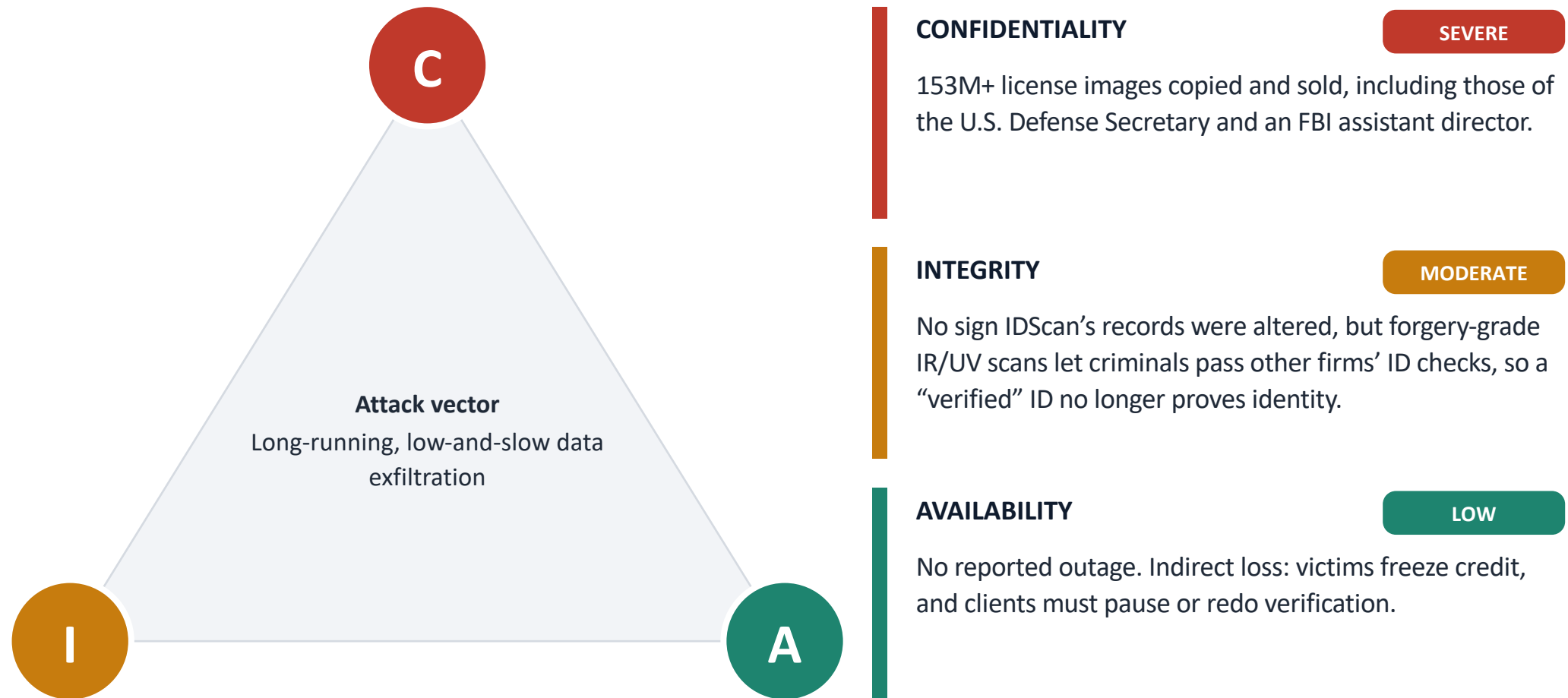
IMPACT

Identity and credit fraud, breach-response costs, and exposure of senior U.S. officials.

TIMELINE

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- Jun 2025**
Earliest matched scan timestamps
 - Aug 31, 2026**
Nexus listed on the Exploit forum
 - Sep 1, 2026**
FBI opens an investigation
 - Sep 8, 2026**
IDScan.net confirms the breach

All three elements were hit, but not equally



Confidentiality was hit hardest: identity can't be reset

153M+

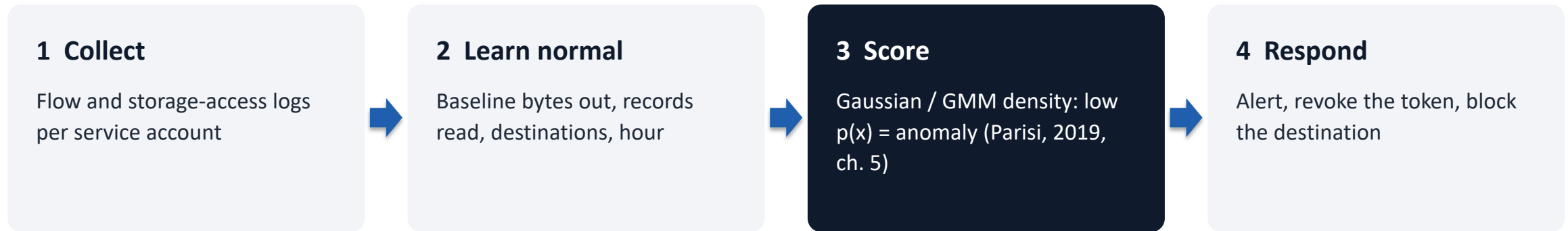
driver's license records exposed

1+ year

of exfiltration before it was detected

- **Irreversible.** A password can be reset; a face, birth date and license number cannot.
- **Forgery-grade.** IR and UV scans are exactly what ID verifiers check.
- **Harm beyond fraud.** Exposes senior officials, abuse survivors and protected witnesses who cannot change their appearance.
- **Root cause.** The integrity and availability damage both flow from this single loss of confidentiality.

Prevention: AI-based egress anomaly detection



Current industry practice: commercial UEBA and network detection and response (NDR) platforms flag exfiltration this way.

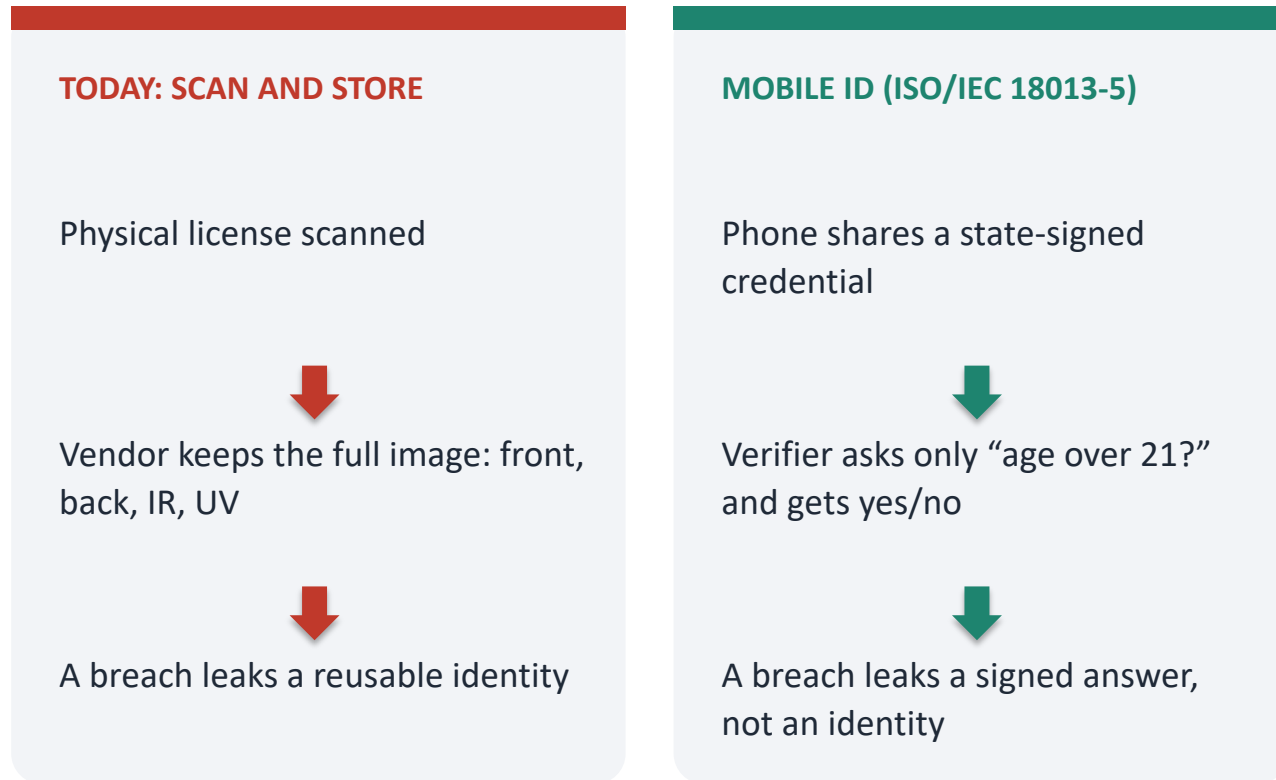
APPLIED TO THIS BREACH

An account that normally reads few images starts sending ~400K records a day to a new host. That falls far outside its baseline, so it is **cut off within hours, not after a year**.

LESSON FROM MY MODULE 1 LAB

My benign-only GMM reached **ROC-AUC 0.966** on CIC-IDS-2017 but missed attacks that look normal flow by flow. Slow leaks need **per-account baselines over days** (UEBA).

Trend: mobile IDs shrink what there is to steal



- **The trend:** mobile driver’s licenses (ISO/IEC 18013-5). TSA accepts digital IDs at 250+ airports and “sees only the necessary information.”
- **Mitigation link:** verifiers never hold an image, so a breach like IDScan’s yields nothing reusable.
- **With the AI control:** minimize what is stored, then monitor what remains.

“We don’t have nearly the oversight to ensure they are safe.” Z. Edwards, privacy researcher, in Krebs (2026)

Reflection and references

WHAT I LEARNED

This case changed how I read my Module 1 detector: a strong score is not enough when an attacker is patient enough to look normal one event at a time.

In security engineering, I want to build detectors that model **behavior over time** and to argue for storing less data.

Three questions I now ask: What do we store? How fast would we notice it leaving? How quickly can we cut it off?

REFERENCES

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